

The esteemed status of Prophet Muhammad ﷺ

In the light of the Qur'ān and Hadith

Allah the Almighty is the creator and sustainer of all the worlds. He has sent His Apostles and revealed books to guide mankind in every era. Prophet Muhammad ﷺ is His last and final Messenger, and the Qur'ān is His last preserved book for the edification of all humanity till the Last Day. All the Apostles of Allah are blessed with esteemed status but Prophet Muhammad ﷺ is the Imam of all these Prophets. Allah the Almighty has venerated him with unique status and ranks. He is the only moderator by whom we have received all the blessings from Allah the Almighty. As his obedience means the obedience of Allah and his disobedience is the disobedience of Allah.

Allah the Almighty has made an obligation on us to love and follow him. We should learn his esteemed status in light of the Qur'ān and Hadith so that we can love him. Without his love, we will not be able to love Allah and follow His commandments. The unique status of Prophet Muhammad ﷺ is discussed comprehensively, which will help to induce his love in our hearts.

Prophet Muhammad's ﷺ status in the Qur'ān

1.

قُلْ إِنْ كُنْتُمْ تُحِبُّونَ اللَّهَ فَاتَّبِعُونِي يُحْبِبْكُمُ اللَّهُ وَيَغْفِرْ لَكُمْ ذُنُوبَكُمْ وَاللَّهُ غَفُورٌ رَحِيمٌ

Say, [O Muhammad], "If you should love Allah, then follow me, [so] Allah will love you and forgive your sins. And Allah is Forgiving and Merciful." (Surah No. 3 Ayah No. 31)

2.

فَلَا وَرَبِّكَ لَا يُؤْمِنُونَ حَتَّى يُحَكِّمُوكَ فِيمَا شَجَرَ بَيْنَهُمْ ثُمَّ لَا يَجِدُوا فِي أَنْفُسِهِمْ حَرَجًا مِمَّا قَضَيْتَ وَيُسَلِّمُوا تَسْلِيمًا

But no, by your Lord, they will not [truly] believe until they make you, [O Muhammad], judge concerning that over which they dispute among themselves and then find within themselves no discomfort from what you have judged and submit in [full, willing] submission. (Surah No. 4 - Ayah No. 65)

3.

وَمَا أَرْسَلْنَاكَ إِلَّا رَحْمَةً لِّلْعَالَمِينَ

And We have not sent you, [O Muhammad], except as a mercy to the worlds. (Surah No. 21 - Ayah No. 107)

4.

إِنَّ اللَّهَ وَمَلَائِكَتَهُ يُصَلُّونَ عَلَى النَّبِيِّ يَا أَيُّهَا الَّذِينَ آمَنُوا صَلُّوا عَلَيْهِ وَسَلِّمُوا تَسْلِيمًا

Allah and His angels send blessings on the Prophet: O ye that believe! Send ye blessings on him, and salute him with all respect. (Surah No. 33 - Ayah No. 56)

5.

يَا أَيُّهَا الَّذِينَ آمَنُوا لَا تَقْدُمُوا بَيِّنَ يَدَيِ اللَّهِ وَرَسُولِهِ وَاتَّقُوا اللَّهَ إِنَّ اللَّهَ سَمِيعٌ عَلِيمٌ يَا أَيُّهَا الَّذِينَ آمَنُوا لَا تَرْفَعُوا أَصْوَاتَكُمْ فَوْقَ صَوْتِ النَّبِيِّ وَلَا تَجْهَرُوا لَهُ بِالْقَوْلِ كَجَهْرِ بَعْضِكُمْ لِبَعْضٍ أَن تَحْبَطَ أَعْمَالُكُمْ وَأَنتُمْ لَا تَشْعُرُونَ

O you who have believed, do not put [yourselves] before Allah and His Messenger but fear Allah. Indeed, Allah is Hearing and Knowing. O you who have believed, do not raise your voices above the voice of the Prophet or be loud to him in speech like the loudness of some of you to others, lest your deeds become worthless while you perceive not. (Surah No. 49 - Ayah No. 1 & 2)

Prophet Muhammad's ﷺ status in the Hadith

We will not be able to attain the essence of Iman until and unless we love Holy Prophet ﷺ more than every relation of our life. As we cannot learn anything without effort and sacrifice, similarly his love also can't be induced automatically we have to learn and strive for his love. That is why Holy Prophet ﷺ said:

“By Him in Whose Hands my life is, none of you will have faith till he loves me more than his father and his children.”

(Sahih al-Bukhari 14)

All the Prophets will show the way of Muhammad ﷺ on the Day of Judgment.

It is stated in a hadith of Bukhari that on the Day of Judgment when all the people will go to Adam, then Nuh, then Ibrahim, then Musa, then Isa but all of them will say we are afraid today that what will happen with us. Today only one man can intercede in the court of Allah the Almighty. Go to Prophet Muhammad ﷺ.

The Holy Prophet ﷺ said:

The people will come to me, and I will prostrate myself underneath Allah's Throne. Then I will be addressed: O Muhammad ﷺ! Raise your head; intercede, for your intercession will be accepted, and ask (for anything) for you will be given.

(Sahih al-Bukhari 3340)

This hadith shows the esteemed status of Prophet Muhammad ﷺ in the court of Allah. When everyone will be afraid of Allah the Almighty only Prophet Muhammad ﷺ will be allowed to speak with Allah directly. Allah the Almighty will not only listen to him but also accept his intercession. Prophet Muhammad ﷺ will not ask for his forgiveness, he will ask for the forgiveness of humanity.

Question of the Grave

As a Muslim we all know that we are going to die one day and in the grave we are going to spend infinite time. We have to answer some questions in the grave. The status of our grave's life will depend upon the answers of these questions. Prophet Muhammad ﷺ has informed us about these questions in his several narrations. One hadith regarding this question is mentioned as follows:

Allah's Apostle ﷺ said, **"When (Allah's) slave is put in his grave and his companions return and he even hears their footsteps, two angels come to him and make him sit and ask, 'What did you use to say about this man (i.e. Muhammad)?' The faithful Believer will say, 'I testify that he is Allah's slave and His Apostle.' Then they will say to him, 'Look at your place in the Hell Fire; Allah has given you a place in Paradise instead of it.' So he will see both his places." (Qatada said, 'We were informed that his grave would be made spacious.' Then Qatada went back to the narration of Anas who said;) Whereas a hypocrite or a non-believer will be asked, 'What did you use to say about this man.' He will reply, 'I do not know; but I used to say what the people used to say.' So they will say to him, 'Neither did you know nor did you take the guidance (by reciting the Qur'an).' Then he will be hit with iron hammers once, that he will send such a cry as everything near to him will hear, except Jinns and human beings."**

(Sahih al-Bukhari 1374)

Knowledge is the essence and soul of this world. The supremacy of mankind over other species is based on knowledge. There are different means to acquire knowledge about everything around us: divine knowledge, deductive reasoning, logical knowledge, philosophical knowledge, scientific knowledge, and several others. All these types differ from one another depending on their nature, scope, source, and methodology. In this era, scientific knowledge has garnered significant attention as it has contributed immensely to shaping modern life.

One should understand a key point: the aim and scope of divine and scientific knowledge are different from each other. There is no competition between the two, nor do they need to contradict each other. As Molana Waheed ud-Deen explains, scientific knowledge addresses the question of *"How,"* while divine knowledge answers the question of *"Who."*

This concept can be illustrated through the example of a chick developing inside the shell of an egg. Scientific knowledge provides the detailed mechanisms of how the chick forms—such as which organ develops first and which develops later. However, the question of *"Who"* remains unchanged: Who initiates life by converting sperm into an embryo, and who shapes it into blood, skin, bones, feathers, and so on? With this example, we can relate to various natural phenomena.

Scientific knowledge explains the phases of human development within a mother's womb, but it cannot answer *"Who"* initiates and orchestrates these processes. Who transforms one cell into a trillion cells? Who converts water into blood, blood into bones, and organizes them into functioning organs? These processes depend on countless fine-tunings. Even a minor deviation can lead to the collapse of the entire system, just as in atomic orbits—unseen to the naked eye—where electrons, protons, and neutrons move in perfect order. We know that a slight change in a magnetic field can disrupt the system entirely. The universe operates under the same principle: countless fine-tunings sustain its harmony.

For example, the Hubble Telescope discovered 10,000 galaxies in a tiny patch of the sky, but the true extent of the universe's complexities—such as the number of stars, planets, black holes, and the light-year distances between them—remains unknown. Our Milky Way galaxy alone contains about 200 billion stars, and our sun is just one among them. A recent solar flare incident highlights the intricate nature of these systems.

Science is not opposed to Islamic or divine knowledge; instead, it complements our understanding of the intelligent design and flawless creation of a single God. Everything in our surroundings is a miracle. Allah Almighty is the only valid explanation for the physical phenomena in nature.

Divine knowledge, revealed by the Creator of the universe, is flawless, unchangeable, and provides absolute certainty. It addresses life's ultimate purpose and the fundamental questions of *"Who."* Scientific knowledge, however, relies on research, experimentation, and empirical evidence. As science advances, theories evolve—for instance, concepts like multiple universes and the expanding universe were unknown a few decades ago.

Scientific and Qur'anic View of the Creation of the Universe (Big Bang Theory)

The Big Bang theory explains the origin of the universe. According to this theory, about 13.8 billion years ago, the universe was condensed into a singular point of matter. This material, referred to by some scientists as a "super atom," was intensely compressed. Eventually, a massive explosion known as the Big Bang caused the universe to expand, forming galaxies,

stars, and planets in a precisely organized manner. This explosion was not a coincidence, as the structure that emerged demonstrates remarkable order and design.

The Qur'an alluded to these facts centuries before modern science reached similar conclusions. The Creator revealed:

> "Do the disbelievers not see that the heavens and the earth were a joined entity, and We separated them? And We made from water every living thing. Will they not then believe?" (Qur'an 21:30)

The Qur'an presented these truths 1,400 years ago, which science has only recently discovered, confirming the divine nature of the Qur'an.

Expanding Universe

The first discovery of the expanding universe came from astronomer Edwin Hubble, who observed that galaxies are moving away from each other. As the distance between them increases, so does their speed. This observation led to the conclusion that the universe itself is expanding. In 1965, two American physicists, Arno Penzias and Robert Wilson, further confirmed this discovery. They were later awarded the Nobel Prize in 1978.

Stephen Hawking described this discovery as one of the greatest intellectual revolutions of the 20th century.

Interestingly, the Qur'an described the expanding universe long before these scientific observations:

> "And We built the heavens with might, and indeed, We are expanding it." (Qur'an 51:47)

The Arabic word **"mūsi'ūn"** indicates continuous expansion, affirming the ongoing growth of the universe. This verse serves as a profound scientific miracle in the Qur'an, demonstrating divine knowledge that aligns with modern discoveries.

Creation of Humans in the Mother's Womb

Allah explains the stages of human creation in the following verse:

> “Then We made the sperm-drop into a clinging clot, and We made the clot into a lump (like chewed flesh), and We made (from) the lump bones, and We covered the bones with flesh. Then We developed him into another creation. So blessed is Allah, the Best of creators.” (Qur'an 23:12-14)

Modern scientific research has confirmed these stages, which align with observations from advanced technology. Dr. Keith Moore, a professor of genetics at the University of Toronto, praised the accuracy of these descriptions when presented with the Qur'anic references on human development.

The Ten Commandments

Allah revealed four sacred books and several scriptures to guide humanity, and the central message of all Prophets was the oneness of Allah (Tawhid). After embracing Tawhid, believers are obligated to follow Allah's commandments in all aspects of life. The Ten Commandments provide a foundational framework for Islamic teachings. While parts of these commandments appear in the Old and New Testaments, they are fully outlined in the Qur'an in Surah Al-Isra (Chapter 17, Verses 23-40).

Tawhid (Oneness of Allah)

The absolute oneness of Allah has already been discussed in detail.

Rights of Parents

Islam is the only religion that offers comprehensive guidance for every aspect of life. A strong family unit forms the foundation of a better society, with parents playing a vital role in nurturing children. Allah elevates the status of parents because of their responsibility in raising future generations.

The Qur'an emphasizes treating parents with kindness:

> “And your Lord has decreed that you worship none but Him, and be kind to parents.” (Qur'an 17:23)

This verse highlights the importance of benevolence towards parents, placing it immediately after the command to worship Allah alone.

1. The Love of the Companions for Prophet Muhammad (PBUH)

- The Companions (Sahabah) are regarded as the best individuals after the Prophet (PBUH) due to their close association and immense love for him.
- **Examples of the Companions' Love:**

1. **Ablution Water:** They would compete to collect the leftover water from the Prophet's ablution as a token of reverence (Sahih al-Bukhari 189).
 2. **Gazing at the Prophet during Prayer:** The hadith narrated by Anas bin Malik shows the joy of seeing the Prophet's face, describing it as more beautiful than anything they had seen (Sahih al-Bukhari 681).
 3. **Abu Ayyub Ansari's Reverence:** When the Prophet stayed at his home in Madinah, Abu Ayyub showed humility by not wanting to live on the upper floor, fearing it would disrespect the Prophet below. He even adjusted his behavior and habits to align with what the Prophet liked (Sahih Muslim 5358, Musnad Ahmad 22471).
- **Lesson:** The true essence of faith lies in loving the Prophet (PBUH) wholeheartedly and following his practices in every aspect of life.

2. The Concept of Ijma (Consensus) in Islamic Law

- **Ijma** refers to the unanimous agreement of scholars (mujtahids) on a particular legal issue after the Prophet's death.
- **Types of Ijma:**
 - **Ijma Qawli (Explicit):** Where scholars explicitly express the same legal opinion.
 - **Ijma Sukuti (Tacit):** When some jurists express a verdict while others remain silent, neither rejecting nor approving it.
- **Quranic and Hadith Evidence for Ijma:**
 - **Quran:** "Whoever opposes the Messenger after guidance has been made clear and follows other than the way of believers, We will leave him to what he has chosen and place him in Hell" (Surah An-Nisa 4:115).
 - **Hadith:** The Prophet (PBUH) said, "My Ummah will not agree upon an error, and Allah's hand is upon the group (jamat)"—emphasizing the validity of collective consensus.

3. Qiyas (Analogy) in Islamic Jurisprudence

- **Definition:** Qiyas involves drawing an analogy between an existing case (with a ruling in Islamic sources) and a new case without a direct ruling, based on a common cause (illah).
- **Example of Qiyas:**
 1. **Prohibition of Khamr (Alcohol):**
The Quran prohibits khamr (wine) because it causes intoxication. By analogy, other intoxicating substances (like drugs) are also prohibited since they share the same effect.
- **Elements of Qiyas:**
 1. **Asl:** The original case (e.g., khamr).
 2. **Far':** The new case (e.g., drugs).

3. **Illah:** The common reason (intoxication).
 4. **Hukm:** The ruling (prohibition).
- **Proof of Qiyas from Hadith:**
When the Prophet (PBUH) sent Mu'adh ibn Jabal to Yemen, he advised him to follow the Quran, then the Sunnah, and finally his own judgment (ijtihad) if the previous sources did not provide a clear ruling.

Conclusion

This content emphasizes the **immense love and reverence** that the Companions had for the Prophet (PBUH), providing us with valuable examples to follow. It also explains **Ijma and Qiyas** as essential components of Islamic jurisprudence, offering practical guidance for resolving issues that arise in different contexts. Together, these concepts illustrate the significance of following the Prophet's teachings, adhering to scholarly consensus, and using analogy to apply Islamic principles to modern situations.

Islamic Teachings on Respecting Parents and Caring for Orphans

1. Reverence for Parents in Islam

- **Tawhid and Parental Rights:**
The Quran emphasizes that worship of Allah should be followed closely by respect for parents. Allah mentions several times that reverence for parents is among the most significant commandments, second only to the worship of Him.
Verse:
"And worship Allah and do not set up any partners with Him and treat the parents with moral excellence."
- **Commandment from Prophet Adam (AS) to Muhammad (PBUH):**
This reverence towards parents has been emphasized from the time of Adam (AS) and was reiterated by Prophet Muhammad (PBUH) as well.
- **Best Deeds in Islam:**
The Prophet Muhammad (PBUH) said:
"The best deed is prayer at its proper time and kindness to the parents."

2. Kindness to Parents in Old Age

- The Quran teaches that children should be especially kind to their parents in old age. They should not even utter words of irritation, such as "Uff," toward them.
Verse:

“If either or both of them attain to old age in your presence, then do not say even ‘Uff!’ to them nor reproach them, and always speak to both with kindness and humility.”

- This commandment reflects the care and unconditional love parents provide throughout life. In their old age, it becomes the children’s duty to repay this love with care and respect.

3. Gratefulness to Parents

- **Being Grateful to Parents and Allah:**

The Quran links gratitude to Allah with gratitude to parents.

Verse:

“Be grateful to Me and to your parents.”

- The Prophet Muhammad (PBUH) emphasized that a person who is not grateful to their parents cannot truly be grateful to Allah.

4. Obedience to Parents

- Disobedience to parents is considered among the major sins in Islam, next to shirk (associating partners with Allah).

Hadith:

“The major sins are: associating anyone with Allah, disobedience to parents, killing a person, and giving false testimony.”

5. Respect for Parents through Behavior

- **Never Abuse Parents:**

The Prophet Muhammad (PBUH) taught that abusing others' parents leads to one's own parents being insulted in return.

Hadith:

“A person abuses the father of another man, who in turn abuses his father. One abuses his mother, and the other abuses his (the former’s) mother.”

6. The Mother’s Status in Islam

- The mother holds a superior status in Islam.

Hadith:

When asked who deserves the most kindness, the Prophet (PBUH) replied three times:

“Your mother, your mother, your mother.” Then, he said: “Your father.”

7. The Father as the Door to Paradise

- The father is described as the “middle door of Paradise,” emphasizing the importance of treating him with respect.

Hadith:

“The father is the middle door of Paradise; it is up to you whether you take advantage of it or not.”

- In another hadith, the Prophet (PBUH) said:
“You and your wealth belong to your father.”
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Islamic Teachings on the Care of Orphans

1. Protection of Orphans' Wealth

- The wealth of orphans must be safeguarded. Guardians are prohibited from misusing orphans' property.

Verse:

“Indeed, those who devour the property of orphans unjustly are consuming fire into their bellies, and they will be burned in a Blaze.”

2. Prohibition Against Corruption in Orphan's Wealth

- Allah warns against even approaching the wealth of orphans improperly.

Verse:

“And do not approach the orphan's property except in a way that is beneficial until he reaches maturity.”

- The Prophet Muhammad (PBUH) included the wrongful consumption of an orphan's wealth among the seven major sins.

Hadith:

“Avoid the seven great destructive sins: shirk, sorcery, unlawful killing, consuming riba (usury), consuming an orphan's wealth, fleeing from battle, and slandering chaste women.”

3. Fair Treatment of Orphans

- Orphans must be treated with fairness and kindness, without discrimination.

Verse:

“Worship Allah and associate nothing with Him. Show kindness to parents, relatives, orphans, the needy, neighbors, and travelers. Indeed, Allah dislikes the arrogant and boastful.”

4. Provision of Basic Needs

- Guardians are responsible for fulfilling orphans' basic needs, including food, clothing, shelter, and healthcare. The Prophet (PBUH) promised a great reward for those who care for orphans.

Hadith:

“The guardian of the orphan and I will be in Paradise like this,” and he held his two fingers close together.

- Another hadith reinforces the same message:
“The one who looks after an orphan, whether a relative or not, will be with me in Paradise like these two fingers.”

5. Educational and Financial Support

- Orphans should be provided with educational opportunities to support their development. This ensures they can lead a dignified life and contribute to society.

Conclusion

Islam places immense importance on respecting parents and providing care for orphans. The Quran and hadiths offer clear guidance on how these responsibilities should be fulfilled. Parents are to be honored throughout their lives, with special care given in old age. Orphans, on the other hand, are to be treated with kindness and fairness, with strict rules in place to protect their rights and property. Both acts—kindness towards parents and caring for orphans—are greatly rewarded in Islam, promising the highest ranks in Paradise.